the rise since 2017, even though it is less voluminous in percentage terms when compared to other issues in its discourse. Far from retreating on its core issues, the BJP has increased its stridency on them. It has, in effect, transformed the syntax of Indian politics—from triple talaq to the Ram Temple (with every major political party supporting the building of the Ram Temple in August 2020) and on Kashmir (no major party opposed the repeal of Article 370 in Parliament in August 2019). The shift in political cultures on Hinduness, started by L.K. Advani in the 1980s, has reached its logical culmination under Narendra Modi. By 2020, even alternative political forces, like Arvind Kejriwal's AAP in Delhi, found it difficult to oppose the CAA and NRC.

However, contrary to popular perception, the BJP is not a one-trick pony. Its core voters know what it stands for, but the party has been aggressively courting new voters through a much more varied overall discourse than is clear from the media headlines alone. This is the central insight of the Narad Index and its findings in this chapter. Even as the BJP rode the chariot of Hindutva, which signalled its ideological differentiation, it rode on the wheels of development, with Modi as its charioteer.

Finally, the BJP can afford to talk less frequently about its special issues, when compared to its discourse on development, because the party communicates to its followers in multiple voices. In fact, the RSS speaks only about these ideological issues, giving the BJP leeway to calibrate its political messaging appropriately. (I have analysed how the RSS communicates in Part IV of this book.)